Key IRDAI Rules at a Glance

Claim timelines, grievance steps and Ombudsman limits with regulation references

The rules that decide most Indian insurance disputes, on one page. Quote the regulation number in your letter — it moves the complaint from opinion to procedure.

Requirement	Who it binds	Rule
Reasons for repudiation must be given in writing; policyholder must be heard	Insurer	Reg. 8, IRDAI (PPI) Regulations, 2017
Grievance at the insurer's grievance cell resolved within 14 days	Insurer	Reg. 3, IRDAI (PPI) Regulations, 2017
Ombudsman complaint allowed after 30 days of insurer silence, or on rejection	Policyholder	Insurance Ombudsman Rules, 2017
Ombudsman complaint within 1 year of the insurer's final decision	Policyholder	Insurance Ombudsman Rules, 2017
Ombudsman monetary limit: Rs. 50 lakh per claim	Ombudsman	Insurance Ombudsman Rules, 2017 (amended Nov 2023)
Cashless authorisation decision within 1 hour of the request (planned admission)	Insurer / TPA	IRDAI health master circular, 2024
Final cashless authorisation within 3 hours where the 1-hour clock started at discharge	Insurer / TPA	IRDAI health master circular, 2024
Claim settlement within 30 days of the last necessary document	Insurer	IRDAI (PPI) Regulations, 2017
No repudiation after 3 years of policy issue on the ground of misrepresentation	Insurer	Section 45, Insurance Act, 1938
Policyholder's free-look period: 30 days	Insurer	IRDAI (PPI) Regulations, 2017
Cancellation of a health policy requires renewal notice and a grace period	Insurer	IRDAI health insurance regulations

Timelines change. Before you cite a number in a filing, check the current text on irdai.gov.in — and cite the version that was in force on the date of the claim decision.

Educational template. It is not legal advice and does not create an advisory relationship. Confirm current timelines with IRDAI, your insurer and the Insurance Ombudsman before you file. Prepared 12 November 2026.